

tmux documentation

tmx-shell-init

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-05-22T12:20:00Z **Authority:** vasic-digital tmux project
Maintainer: milosvasic **Scope:** §11.4.18 script companion doc for `scripts/tmx-shell-init.sh`

Purpose

Single project-owned entry point sourced from the operator's `.bashrc` / `.zshrc`. Replaces the hand-pasted, drift-prone snippet that previously lived in every operator's rc file. On every interactive login it prompts for a session name, defaulting to `default` (the literal token `default` AND blank input both mean SKIP — bare shell, no tmx wrapping). Any other name routes through the tmx wrapper, which in turn restores the session's last cwd via the Go state daemon. Design authority: `docs/superpowers/specs/2026-05-22-tmx-shell-session-resume-design.md` §4.A + §5.2.

Usage

One-time install — append to `~/ .bashrc` AND `~/ .zshrc`:

```
# vasic-digital tmx shell integration
. /path/to/tmux/scripts/tmx-shell-init.sh
```

(or use the generated `scripts/bashrc_snippet.template` produced by `scripts/setup.sh`, which already embeds the project's resolved path plus the PATH block).

Manual one-shot probe (no install required):

```
# Source it interactively to test.
. scripts/tmx-shell-init.sh

# Or run it under a sub-shell, with stdin redirected (non-TTY
  guard
# MUST silently no-op, never block, never error):
bash -c '. scripts/tmx-shell-init.sh' </dev/null
echo "exit=$? ← MUST be 0"
```

Concrete operator session walk-through:

```
$ ssh nezha
[tmx] session name (default = skip, blank = skip): work
[tmx] resuming 'work' (last cwd: /home/m/Projects/tmux)
... tmx new -s work runs, attaches, drops you in the recalled cwd ...
```

```
$ ssh nezha
[tmx] session name (default = skip, blank = skip): <enter>
... no tmx; you're in a bare login shell ...
```

Inputs

- **stdin (TTY)** — single line read; trimmed; coerced to default on empty input.
- **\$TMUX** — if non-empty, script silently returns (don't nest tmux servers per spec §6 edge case 4).
- **\$TMX_SHELL_INIT_SKIP** — operator escape hatch; if non-empty, script silently returns. Useful in CI and one-off `bash -c` flows.
- **\$TMX_HOSTNAME** — optional override propagated downstream to the wrapper for status-bar colour stability.
- **TTY check** — `[ -t 0 ] && [ -t 1 ]`; non-TTY contexts (`scp`, `rsync`, IDE remote shells, automated SSH commands) silently no-op per spec §6 edge case 5.

Outputs

- **stdout** — the operator prompt and one-line `[tmx] resuming X` banner on session entry.
- **stderr** — name-validation rejection messages (forbidden characters per spec §6 edge case 3).
- **process exec** — on success, execs the tmx wrapper, which in turn execs `tmux attach`. The operator's shell is replaced; no fork is left behind.

Side-effects

- Reads one line from `stdin` (only when TTY-guarded).
- May exec `tmx new -s <name>` or `exec tmx attach -t <name>`, replacing the calling shell.
- Never writes to disk directly. The downstream wrapper + state daemon handle persistence per `docs/scripts/tmx-state.md`.

Dependencies

- POSIX `sh` (works in `bash` 3.2+ — the macOS default — and in `zsh` 5+; parses clean under `sh -n` per §11.4.67).
- The `tmx` wrapper on `$PATH` (or referenced via the project path the template substitution baked in).
- Optional but recommended: `scripts/tmx-state-bin` for `cwd` restore; absence is non-fatal (wrapper falls back to `$HOME`).

Cross-references

- Design spec: `docs/superpowers/specs/2026-05-22-tmx-shell-session-resume-design.md`
- Operator user guide: `docs/guides/tmx-shell-integration.md` (P8 deliverable)
- Companion script docs: `docs/scripts/tmx-state.md`, `docs/scripts/tmx-ssh-dispatch.md`, `docs/scripts/tmx-ssh-install.md`

- Wrapper integration: `scripts/tmx.template` (P4 — the `cwd-restore` + `hook-install` machinery)
- Runtime tests:
 - `scripts/tests/19_default_skip.sh` (literal default SKIPS)
 - `scripts/tests/20_default_skip_blank.sh` (blank SKIPS)
 - `scripts/tests/21_non_tty_skip.sh` (non-TTY SKIPS silently)
 - `scripts/tests/26_session_name_validation.sh` (forbidden chars)
 - `scripts/tests/28_nested_tmux_skip.sh` (`$TMUX` set SKIPS)
- Constitution: §11.4.18 (script docs), §11.4.6 (no-guessing — every prompt response handled deterministically), §11.4.67 (POSIX parseability), §11.4.81 (cross-platform — same script works on macOS bash 3.2 and Linux bash 5 / zsh).

Last verified

2026-05-22 — sibling PWU P2 published the script and its `sh -n` parse-clean evidence; this companion doc tracks its contract. Full on-device runtime coverage gated on PWU P6.